

## Present subjunctive

The present subjunctive in Spanish (*el presente de subjuntivo*) is **a verb mood used to express wishes, doubts, and emotions**. It typically appears in sentences with a change of subject connected by the word *que*.  YouTube · BaseLang +1

### How to Form It

- **The "Yo" Step:** Take the *yo* form of the present indicative, drop the *-o*, and add the opposite endings.
- **-AR Verbs Endings:** *-e, -es, -e, -emos, -éis, -en* (Example for *hablar*: *hable, hables, hable, hablemos, habléis, hablen*).
- **-ER / -IR Verbs Endings:** *-a, -as, -a, -amos, -áis, -an* (Example for *comer*: *coma, comas, coma, comamos, comáis, coman*).  YouTube · Spanish With ... +2

### When to Use It

- **Wishes and Desires:** *Quiero que vengas* (I want you to come).
- **Doubts and Uncertainty:** *Dudo que llueva* (I doubt it will rain).
- **Emotions:** *Me alegro de que estés aquí* (I am glad you are here).  YouTube · BaseLang +2

If you'd like, I can:

- Provide a list of **irregular verbs** in this mood (like *ir*, *ser*, or *saber*).
- Give you a **practice exercise** with answers.

Let me know how you want to proceed!

## 1. Irregular Verbs (The "DISHES" Acronym)

The easiest way to memorize the six completely irregular verbs in the present subjunctive is with the word **DISHES**. These do not follow the "Yo" step rule.

| Verb  | English       | Subjunctive Forms (Yo / Tú / Él / Nosotros / Vosotros / Ellos) |
|-------|---------------|----------------------------------------------------------------|
| Dar   | To give       | dé, des, dé, demos, deis, den                                  |
| Ir    | To go         | vaya, vayas, vaya, vayamos, vayáis, vayan                      |
| Ser   | To be         | sea, seas, sea, seamos, seáis, sean                            |
| Haber | To have (aux) | haya, hayas, haya, hayamos, hayáis, hayan                      |
| Estar | To be         | esté, estés, esté, estemos, estéis, estén                      |
| Saber | To know       | sepa, sepa, sepa, sepamos, sepáis, sepan                       |

## 2. Breakdown of the WEIRDO Acronym

The **WEIRDO** acronym classifies the situations and trigger verbs that force you to use the subjunctive mood in the secondary clause (after the word *que*).

- **W – Wishes, Desires, & Imperatives:** Asking, wanting, or ordering someone to do something.
  - *Triggers:* Querer (to want), Desear (to desire), Esperar (to hope), Preferir (to prefer), Insistir en (to insist on).
  - *Example:* Quiero que tú **vayas** al supermercado. (I want you to go to the supermarket.) 📍
- **E – Emotion:** Expressing how a situation makes you feel.
  - *Triggers:* Alegrarse de (to be glad), Temer (to fear), Tener miedo de (to be afraid of), Sentir (to be sorry/regret), Molestar (to bother).

- *Example:* Me alegra que **estés** aquí. (I'm glad you are here.)
- **I – Impersonal Expressions:** Subjective, value-judgment statements starting with "It is...".
  - *Triggers:* Es bueno que (It's good that), Es importante que (It's important that), Es posible que (It's possible that), Es una lástima que (It's a shame that).
  - *Example:* Es necesario que nosotros **estudiemos**. (It is necessary that we study.)
- **R – Recommendations & Requests:** Advising, suggesting, or asking someone to act.
  - *Triggers:* Recomendar (to recommend), Sugerir (to suggest), Pedir (to ask/request), Aconsejar (to advise).
  - *Example:* Te sugiero que **sepas** la verdad. (I suggest that you know the truth.)

- **D – Doubt, Denial, & Disbelief:** Expressing uncertainty or stating that something is not true.
  - *Triggers:* Dudar (to doubt), No creer (to not believe), Negar (to deny), No pensar (to not think).
  - *Example:* Dudo que **sea** verdad. (I doubt it is true.)
- **O – Ojalá:** An Arabic-derived Spanish word meaning "hopefully," "let's hope," or "God willing." It *always* triggers the subjunctive and does not require the word *que* (though *que* is optional).
  - *Example:* ¡Ojalá **tengas** un buen día! (Hopefully, you have a good day!)